

ENGLISH EDITION 

DIECAST CAR MAGAZINE

MINIVERSE

SPECIAL COLLABORATION WITH "PAROLA GROUP"

ISSUE 2 JAN-FEB 2026

**ENGINEERED
TO INTIMIDATE**



*WHERE SPEED MEETS
RESTRAINT*

***FAST &
FURIOUS***

EXCLUSIVE INTERVIEW

COVER IMAGE: BMW M2 G87 1/64 HOWIE MODEL WITH ZUKURI PROJECT WHEELS
PHOTOS BY: ANTHONYPHOTOWORKS2



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MODEL OF THE MONTH

MINIVERSE
MAGAZINE



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MINIVERSE MAGAZINE



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WELCOME MINIVERSE MAGAZINE



Dear Miniverse Family,

We are thrilled and proud to present our second issue. The feedback, shares, and support we received after our first issue have once again shown us how meaningful this journey truly is. Miniverse is more than just a magazine; it is the voice of a community filled with passion for diecast, stories, memories, and creativity.

In this issue, we explore different aspects of the collection world in greater depth. In our exclusive interviews, we hosted masters and collectors who have made diecast passion the center of their lives; their stories have been a true source of inspiration for us. Through detailed reviews of rare models and special content showcasing photography techniques, we aim to offer new perspectives to both beginners and experienced collectors alike.

The spirit of Miniverse goes beyond simply showcasing model cars; it is about highlighting the efforts, passions, and dreams of every collector. Because we know that diecast is not just collecting—it is an art, a culture, and a lifestyle that becomes more beautiful when shared. Through the pages of this issue, you will not only discover the technical details of the models but also feel the stories, passion, and imagination behind them.

We sincerely thank all the friends who contributed to this issue. With your support, Miniverse continues to grow and evolve. We warmly invite anyone who wants to be featured in future issues, share their collections, or showcase their photography. Miniverse exists because of you, and as you share, we become stronger.

Finally, on this journey of passion that you will feel in every page, every shot, and every detail, we wish you enjoyable reading, inspiring moments, and days filled with countless models. Remember, every model has a story, and every story carries a passion waiting to be shared.

We would like to extend our heartfelt thanks to our valued friends **Serkan Baş, Volkan Özvatan, Mert Özdal, Gürül Cengizoğlu, and Furkan Örucü**—for their dedication, contributions, and vision. On behalf of the Miniverse Team, we are truly grateful that you are part of this journey and that you share the passion that drives our miniature world forward.

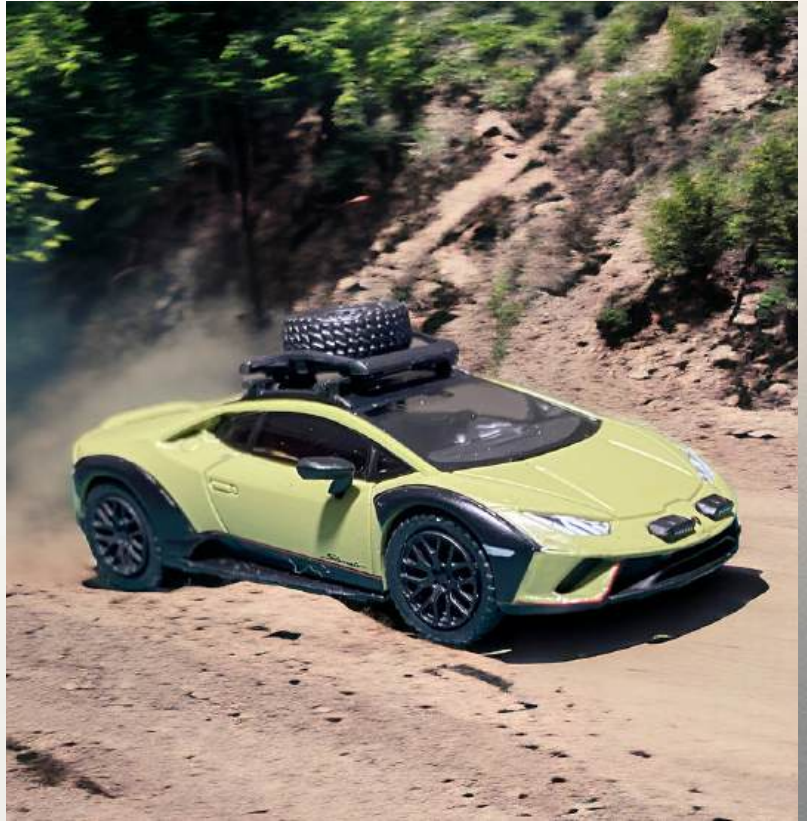
With love and gratitude,


Editor-in-Chief

THE AI REVOLUTION IN MODEL PHOTOGRAPHY: A NEW ERA FOR COLLECTORS

MODEL PHOTOGRAPHY HAS LONG BEEN ONE OF THE MOST CREATIVE PILLARS OF THE DIECAST WORLD. IN RECENT YEARS, HOWEVER, THE DRIVING FORCE BEHIND ITS RAPID EVOLUTION HAS UNDENIABLY BEEN ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE. AI NOT ONLY ENHANCES REALISM AND IMAGE QUALITY, BUT ALSO ACCELERATES PRODUCTION, INTRODUCES FRESH VISUAL STYLES, AND BRINGS A PROFESSIONAL TOUCH TO COLLECTORS' CREATIVE WORKFLOWS.

THIS ARTICLE EXPLORES THE RISE OF AI IN MODEL PHOTOGRAPHY, THE LEADING APPLICATIONS IN THE FIELD, AND THE LATEST TRANSFORMATIONS SHAPING MODERN COLLECTING CULTURE.



Why AI-Powered Model Photography Is Rapidly Growing

Collectors today seek to share more than just photos of their models—they want to convey a story, a mood, and an atmosphere. AI has become a groundbreaking partner in this process, redefining how scenes are imagined and created.

Key Contributions:

- Realistic background generation: Automatically designed scenes with accurate lighting, depth, and perspective tailored to the model.
- Professional lighting simulation: Studio-grade highlights, shadows, and reflections for users with limited equipment.
- Detail enhancement and color refinement: Sharper lines, more defined metallic paint textures, and balanced contrasts.
- Fast post-production: One-touch corrections for tone, composition, and color harmony.

AI is no longer just a retouching tool—it has become a co-creator of the photograph's narrative.



POPULAR AI TOOLS USED IN MODEL PHOTOGRAPHY (UPDATED LIST)

As AI adoption increases, collectors gain more creative freedom and accelerate their ability to produce eye-catching images. Here are the most widely used tools in the community today:

THE AI REVOLUTION IN MODEL PHOTOGRAPHY

PHOTOGRAPHY BY **BULUT GEZER**

★ 1. Midjourney

- The most popular platform for generating cinematic, lifelike atmospheres.
- Excels at racing tracks, neon cities, studio lighting, and dramatic compositions.



★ 2. Adobe Photoshop (Generative Fill)

- Essential for creators seeking professional-level editing.
- Delivers flawless results for background expansion, shadow creation, lighting adjustments, and detail reconstruction.



★ 3. Luminar Neo AI

- Optimizes color, lighting, and mood with a single tap.
- “Dramatic AI” and “Atmosphere AI” filters work exceptionally well with diecast photography



★ 4. CapCut & Canva AI

- Ideal for quick social media content.
- Offers AI-powered templates for reels, stories, posts, and stylized visuals.



★ 5. Lensa & Remini

- Perfect for enhancing low-resolution images.
- Highlights metallic paint, reflections, body lines, and wheel details with impressive clarity.



★ 6. PhotoRoom

- One of the fastest and cleanest tools for background removal and replacement.
- “Magic Studio” instantly places the model into various themed scenes with accurate lighting.



★ 7. Grok

- Increasingly popular for generating fast concepts and scene suggestions.
- Can propose creative themes based on the model's brand, color, or style.
- Excellent for magazine layouts and humorous or unique content.



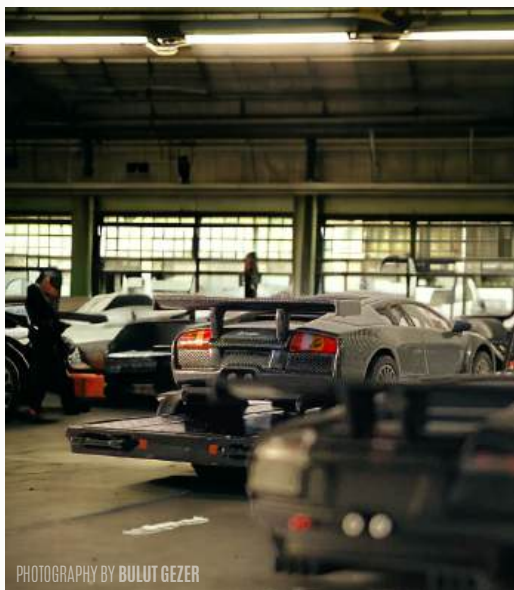
★ 8. Gemini Nano (Banana)

- One of the most powerful on-device AI models for mobile photography.
- Instantly enhances:
 - lighting,
 - shadows,
 - background composition
 - directly on your phone.
- Works offline—ideal for outdoor shooting and quick edits on the go.



HOW AI IS TRANSFORMING THE CULTURE OF COLLECTIBLE PHOTOGRAPHY

08



AI's influence extends far beyond technical enhancements; it has reshaped the creative habits of the entire hobby.

♥ Next-Generation Scene Design

AI allows collectors to create digital dioramas without physical setups. This means:

- Larger environments
- Deeper backgrounds
- More cinematic camera angles

A 1:64 Lamborghini Huracán can now be placed on a foggy night racetrack or a Mediterranean coastline in seconds.

♥ Faster Production & Multiple Variations

From a single photo, users can generate:

- Alternative lighting conditions
- New backgrounds
- Instagram-ready color filters

This has significantly increased posting frequency and accelerated content production.

♥ Higher Engagement Rates

AI-generated atmospheric photos consistently receive:

- More likes
- More comments
- Higher save rates

Because of this, AI-enhanced diecast content has surged across collector pages.

♥ Brands Are Adopting AI Too

Companies like Mini GT, Tarmac Works, and Hot Wheels Premium now incorporate AI-generated renders and scenes in their official campaigns. This parallel evolution between brands and collectors is pushing the hobby into a more professional visual era.



Artificial intelligence has become far more than a tool in model photography—

it has evolved into a creative partner capable of shaping aesthetics, storytelling, atmosphere, and lighting.

For collectors, mastering these tools not only elevates the hobby's enjoyment but also transforms their images into professional-level visual experiences. Today's AI-enhanced creators aren't just taking photos—they're crafting immersive stories.



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**“ALL PHOTOS EDITED
WITH PHOTOROOM”**



REALISM IN MINIATURE: ANTHONY'S CINEMATIC JOURNEY INTO DIECAST PHOTOGRAPHY



PHOTOS BY: ANTHONYPHOTOWORKS2

DIECAST PHOTOGRAPHY IS MORE THAN CAPTURING SMALL-SCALE MODELS – IT IS THE ART OF RECREATING REALITY THROUGH LIGHT, ANGLES, AND STORYTELLING. WITH AN ACADEMIC BACKGROUND IN STUDIO LIGHTING AND PRODUCT PHOTOGRAPHY, ANTHONY TRANSFORMED DIECAST MODELS INTO A POWERFUL MEDIUM FOR CINEMATIC EXPRESSION. IN THIS INTERVIEW, WE EXPLORE THE ORIGINS OF HIS PASSION, HIS CREATIVE PROCESS, AND HIS VISION FOR THE FUTURE OF DIECAST CULTURE.

BULUT GEZER: How did you first get into diecast photography, and when did this passion evolve into a true form of art for you?

ANTHONY: This started from newspaper article it contents about Porsche Carrera GT, and it's getting stronger when i'm work on campus studio as a lecture assistant, at this time i'm learn about the lighting effects on product photography, and the objects of my experiment is diecast, since then i started to have passion in diecast photography.

BG: When planning a photoshoot, what is the first element you focus on? Do you prioritize the scene, lighting, scale accuracy, or model selection?

A: First thing is the references, just google it first to analyze about the lighting position, the angle, and composition. For diorama the scene, lighting is the most important, first we must find the good lighting position, and compose the diecast, figures, creating the realistic and cinematic scene

REALISM AND CINEMATIC VISION IN DIECAST PHOTOGRAPHY

BG: Your iconic shots capture realism perfectly. What techniques do you use to achieve such natural and cinematic results?

A: Clean background : using the photo stacking to make sure the car is all sharp, and light stacking as well to make sure sexy look on the car, with proper light small car can look realistic. For diorama i'm using sunlight, the good position is 3:00 – 4:30 pm afternoon, and 6:00–8:00 am in the morning.

REALISM IN MINIATURE: ANTHONY'S CINEMATIC JOURNEY INTO DIECAST PHOTOGRAPHY

PHOTOS BY: ANTHONYPHOTOWORKS2



BG: In your opinion, what are the three essential rules for creating a perfect diecast photograph?

A: The lighting : this is the most important

The idea : for diecast photography i'm usually google first before zshoot

The sexy angle of the car : every car have different sexy angle.

BG: Among all diecast brands and series, which one inspires you the most? And which models do you enjoy photographing the most?

A: Tomica limited vintage, specially the classic , like porsche 911, alfa romeo, this car is absolutely sexy in every angle

BG: What are your thoughts on the recent growth of diecast communities and the impact of social media on the hobby? How do you see the future of diecast culture?

A: Nowadays there is so may community, for just sharing, buy and sell, the impact is the information about diecast is easier to find (even if some collectible item still hard to find), and easier to learn, in the future the diecast culture will be very segmented, but the most important things is we must support young generations to improve they creativity, because from that creativity can be the opportunity to make business, it's supported by community

BG: What is the most challenging part of your shooting process, and how do you overcome these challenges?

A: The editing, from college my lecture taught me to make sure the photo is good first and after that comes the editing, so i always make sure that i'm doing less editing so i make the photo as good as possible to make the editing is easier.

BG: What is the most valuable piece of advice you would give to beginners or collectors who want to improve their photography skills?

A: Keep learning and exploring, maybe now everyone see us great, but don't forget there is always be someone better than us, keep learning from everyone, and stay humble to everyone.

ANTHONY'S PERSPECTIVE CLEARLY SHOWS THAT A COMPELLING PHOTOGRAPH IS NOT BUILT ON EXPENSIVE EQUIPMENT, BUT ON STRONG IDEAS, PRECISE LIGHTING, AND PATIENCE. HIS EMPHASIS ON REALISM, CONTINUOUS LEARNING, AND SUPPORTING YOUNGER GENERATIONS HIGHLIGHTS THE TRUE SPIRIT OF THE DIECAST COMMUNITY. THIS INTERVIEW STANDS AS AN INSPIRING GUIDE FOR PHOTOGRAPHERS AND COLLECTORS WHO BELIEVE THAT EVEN THE SMALLEST SCALE CAN TELL THE BIGGEST STORIES.



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THE FAST AND THE FURIOUS COLLECTION PASSION: A STORY BEYOND THE SERIES

A COLLECTING JOURNEY THAT EXTENDS FROM MODELS TO FRIENDSHIPS

Bulut Gezer: Fast & Furious is more than just a movie franchise; it's a universe where speed, street culture, and automotive passion come together and inspire millions. This world has elevated diecast collecting to an entirely new level. In this interview, we dive into the perspective of a collector who has built an impressive array of variations over the years. Behind every model lies effort, emotion, and sometimes even a friendship born from the journey.

BG: How did you start collecting the Fast & Furious series, and what makes it special for you?

AÇ: I've been interested in car movies since childhood—engine sounds, tuning culture, speed... all of it always fascinated me. Fast & Furious is the series where I felt this passion the most intensely. Since it brings together both action and automotive culture, I naturally started collecting the scaled-down versions of the cars I saw in the films. Over time, it became more than just a hobby; it turned into a way for me to express myself.



BG: Which model in your collection excites you the most or carries the strongest emotional value? Why?

AÇ: I don't distinguish between cheap or expensive pieces—every model is valuable to me because each one carries effort. But the Volkswagen Touran "Hulk" from Tokyo Drift holds a very special place. While acquiring and customizing this piece, I went through a serious argument, yet that process eventually led to an important friendship in my life. In addition, the contribution of Alperen Tuğrul, who has put effort into this model and many others, makes it even more meaningful. That's why this model represents not only a part of my collection but also a memory and a journey built on shared dedication.

COLLECTION PASSION: A STORY BEYOND THE SERIES

THE FAST AND THE FURIOUS



BG: Owning so many variations of the series must take a lot of dedication. Which piece was the hardest to find or the one you chased the longest?

AÇ: By far, the most challenging piece was the Armadillo. We created it entirely from scratch—starting with our own drawings, then moving into the 3D printing stage. Its size, the fact that it looks like a single large piece, and our goal of achieving a true 1:64 scale made the process even harder. Even finding the right printer for the job was a challenge. But after days of work, the final result was absolutely worth all the effort.

BG: The Fast & Furious universe keeps expanding. How do you think the new movies and models affect the collecting world? What are your expectations?

AÇ: New movies mean new models, and that's always exciting for collectors like us. Even the more absurd designs sometimes end up inspiring great custom builds. My only expectation is that the series doesn't drift too far away from realism and the original street-culture spirit. At its core, Fast & Furious is about that authentic street vibe. As long as they keep that alive, both the films and the models remain enjoyable.



BG: Do you own any variations with production errors, special releases, or limited editions? If so, could you share the stories behind them?

AÇ: I mainly focus on Hot Wheels' Fast & Furious line. The one I worked hardest to complete was the 2013 Hot Wheels FF set. I chased it for two years. There were moments when it was discouraging, but finally completing the entire set became a source of pride and happiness for me.

BG: What advice would you give to beginners, especially those who want to collect the Fast & Furious series?

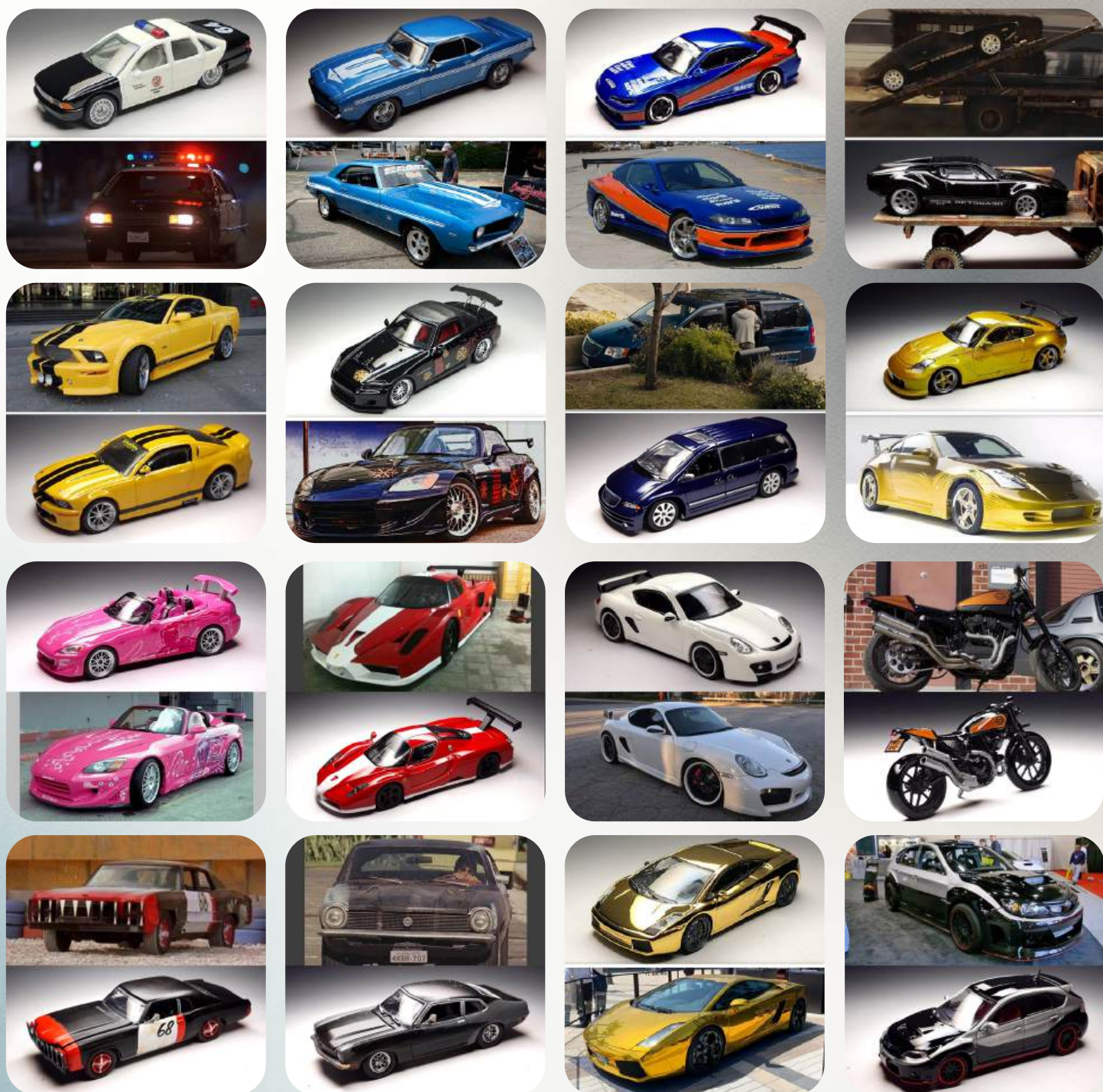
AÇ: The most important rule of collecting is not to rush. A series isn't completed in a day—it comes together over time, and that process is what gives it value. For those starting with Fast & Furious, I recommend the Hot Wheels FF line as the foundation. Also, don't overlook the new plexi brands entering the market. And above all, don't look at these pieces as "toys"—see them as a hobby and a culture. With that mindset, your collection becomes much more meaningful.



THE FAST AND THE FURIOUS

Fast & Furious collecting is a unique journey shaped by patience, passion, and true dedication. Every new film, every new model, and every new story adds another layer of excitement. This interview once again reveals why this culture—built not only on diecast models but also on memories and passion—holds such a special place for collectors.

PHOTOGRAPH ALPEREN TUĞRUL



PHOTOGRAPH ALPEREN TUĞRUL

THE FAST AND THE FURIOUS



THE FAST AND THE FURIOUS

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THE FAST AND THE FURIOUS





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THE FAST AND THE FURIOUS



THE FAST AND THE FURIOUS

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MODEL CAR SHOW 1

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ARMADA'DA BULUŞUYORUZ



ARMADA
ALışveriş ve iş MERKEZİ

17-18 OCAK

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MODEL CAR SHOW 1



DOGUKAN
MANCO



A SILENT JOURNEY OF PASSION: A STORY REFLECTED FROM COLLECTION TO LIFE

SOME COLLECTIONS ARE NOT JUST MADE OF OBJECTS; THEY ARE SHAPED BY MEMORIES, EMOTIONS, AND TIME. THIS INTERVIEW OFFERS AN INTIMATE LOOK AT HOW A CHILDHOOD PASSION FOR DIECAST CARS EVOLVED INTO A PERSONAL SANCTUARY, A WAY OF LIFE, AND A UNIVERSAL LANGUAGE SHARED WITH PEOPLE AROUND THE WORLD.

BULUT GEZER: At what age did collecting become a hobby for you, and how did it start? Do you remember your first model?

EMRE BALCI: I started my diecast car collection in 2002 with a 1:43 scale yellow Chevy Bel Air. I was 14 years old at the time. That model is still part of my collection today, preserved in its original condition. It represents both the beginning of my journey and a piece with great sentimental value.

BG: Is collecting more of a passion for you, or a way to relax and escape from daily life?

EB: At first, it began with my passion for real cars. Over time, however, it evolved into an emotion so strong that it almost made me forget real automobiles altogether. My room has become a personal sanctuary for me — a closed door, complete silence, and full focus on my models. It allows me to leave behind daily fatigue, work stress, and the chaos of life. It truly helps me relax.





BG: Which moment gives you the most pleasure during this hobby: finding a new model, or photographing and sharing it?

EB: Taking photos and shooting videos is definitely enjoyable. However, finding a model I have been searching for a long time, buying it, and especially opening it, gives me a much deeper sense of joy.

BG: What motivates you most when collecting? Rarity, aesthetics, the story behind the model, or purely personal taste?

EB: Rarity is important, but if I don't enjoy a model, its rarity means nothing to me. Some regular production models have made me far happier than limited-edition resin pieces. In the end, the most important factor is the feeling the model gives me.

BG: What is the most fun, funny, or unforgettable moment you've experienced during your hobby?

EB: It's not directly about finding a model, but it's a story we still talk about today — one of our most unexpected reels. At a time when my room had run out of space, I found a wooden strip online, about three meters long and very inexpensive. That's when the idea came to build a display shelf on the door itself.

Everything was ready, and just before we started, a friend suggested recording the process. We ended up with nearly two hours of footage and a perfectly built door display. Of course, a two-hour reel wasn't possible, so I sped the video up to the maximum and shared it.

For us, it was a very simple and unpolished post. Until it reached 42 million views and the Hot Wheels Official account commented on it. To this day, we still can't fully explain how such a spontaneous video achieved such an unbelievable reach. 😊





BG: Do you have a memorable story you often share with friends or followers about your collection?

EB: Yes, a short but unforgettable one. During a summer holiday, a follower recognized me and jumped into the pool with their phone just to come over and take a photo with me. Thankfully, nothing happened to the phone. After getting out and getting dressed, we took the photo. I definitely wouldn't want my naked photos circulating online. 😂

BG: What has this hobby given you on a personal level? Patience, discipline, creativity — or something else?

EB: Above all, it has given me many great friendships. I've met wonderful people from all around the world. You are one of them, for example.

BG: How do you imagine developing your collection in the future? Is there a new style, method, or special project you want to pursue?

EB: Eventually, I will leave my entire collection to my daughter — that's certain. Until then, my biggest dream is to create an open exhibition space where anyone can visit and see the collection in person. I am currently working toward this goal, and my model acquisitions continue with this vision in mind.

I don't know what time will bring, but one day, being able to welcome everyone to visit my collection would be my greatest happiness.

SOME COLLECTIONS ARE NOT JUST MADE OF OBJECTS; THEY ARE SHAPED BY MEMORIES, EMOTIONS, AND TIME. THIS INTERVIEW OFFERS AN INTIMATE LOOK AT HOW A CHILDHOOD PASSION FOR DIECAST CARS EVOLVED INTO A PERSONAL SANCTUARY, A WAY OF LIFE, AND A UNIVERSAL LANGUAGE SHARED WITH PEOPLE AROUND THE WORLD.



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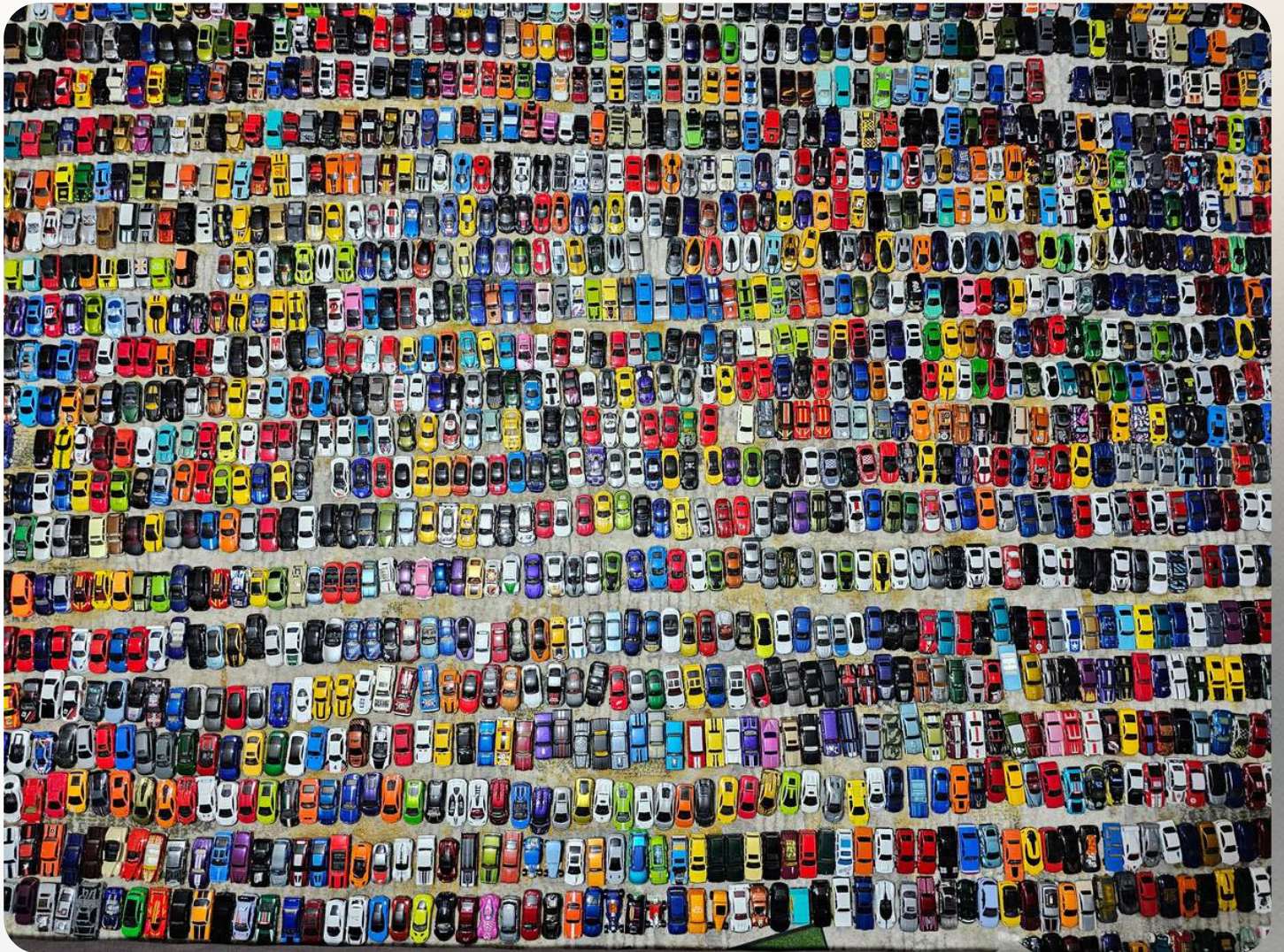
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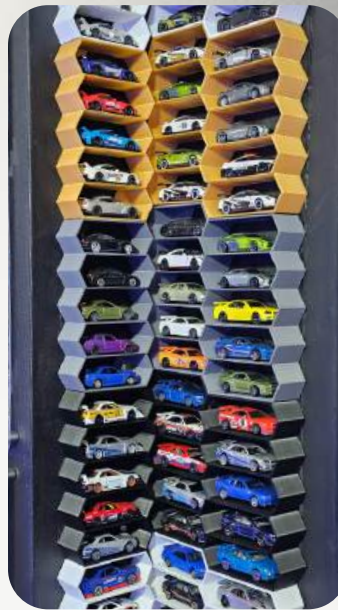


PHOTOGRAPH EMRE BALCI



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BEYOND THE SCALE: STORYTELLING THROUGH DIECAST COLLECTING AND PHOTOGRAPHY

DIECAST COLLECTING AND PHOTOGRAPHY IS A UNIQUE FIELD THAT REQUIRES BOTH DEDICATION AND PASSION. IN THIS INTERVIEW, WE HAD AN INSPIRING CONVERSATION WITH A COLLECTOR WHO BRINGS HIS OWN STYLE AND PERSPECTIVE TO THE MODEL WORLD, EXPLORING EVERYTHING FROM HOW HIS JOURNEY BEGAN TO THE TECHNIQUES BEHIND HIS IMPRESSIVE SHOTS.

BULUT GEZER: How did you first get into diecast collecting? What was the initial detail that drew you into this hobby?

BURAK ÜNÜR: My introduction to diecast collecting goes back to childhood, just like many others who grew up playing with small toy cars. In the 1990s, I started buying Majorette models with the money I saved from my school allowance. During my university years, what drew me into this hobby more professionally was the realism of the 1/18 AutoArt models.



BG: Your shots have a very strong sense of composition. What do you pay the most attention to when planning a photograph?

BÜ: I don't follow a specific plan — I can say my process is completely spontaneous. The only thing I really pay attention to is sunlight, because seeing the color and paint of the models under natural sunlight gives a completely different kind of pleasure.



BG: Which models in your collection hold a special place for you, both in terms of photography and their story?

BÜ: I don't have a model in my collection that holds a special personal story, but in terms of paint and build quality, I do prefer certain brands over others.



BG: Do you use any special techniques or indispensable equipment to achieve realism in your photos?

BÜ: The most important technique I use to capture realism is natural sunlight. My indispensable equipment, however, is the professional camera I bought during my university years.





BG: In your opinion, what is the strongest aspect of the diecast collecting and photography community in Türkiye? How do you see the future of this culture?

BÜ: In my opinion, only a small portion of people in our country are truly engaged in collecting. Many do not collect models patiently or with a specific goal. Instead, they try to buy every new model that comes out, or they purchase items thinking, "This might gain value; I can sell it later."

The number of people involved in diecast photography is even smaller. Still, even the small amount of interest makes me happy, because photographing my models is what brings me the most enjoyment.

BG: What is the most important advice you would give to new collectors who want to both build a collection and take high-quality photos?

BÜ: For new collectors who want to build a collection and take high-quality photos at the same time, my biggest advice is to be patient. If they don't decide which direction they want their collection to grow, they may struggle financially and end up with a scattered collection. This direction can be built around a specific brand, a national automotive style, or a particular model manufacturer. Speaking from my own experience, the key to taking quality photos is to keep shooting constantly without getting tired of the process. I can give the same advice to younger collectors as well.



THE DIECAST COMMUNITY CONTINUES TO GROW, SHAPED BY NEW MODELS AND THE STORIES THEY CARRY. THIS INTERVIEW AIMS TO INSPIRE THOSE WHO ARE JUST STARTING THEIR COLLECTING JOURNEY AS WELL AS THOSE LOOKING TO IMPROVE THEIR PHOTOGRAPHY. WITH THE RIGHT PASSION AND DIRECTION, ANYONE CAN CREATE THEIR OWN DISTINCTIVE STORY WITHIN THIS HOBBY.

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MORE THAN 1/64: UTKU KANAT'S WORLD OF PRECISION, REALISM, AND PASSION

IN THE 1/64 SCALE DIECAST WORLD, THE DETAILS THAT TRULY STAND OUT ARE OFTEN SUBTLE—HARD TO NOTICE AT FIRST GLANCE, YET UNMISTAKABLE ONCE FELT. UTKU KANAT IS ONE OF THE CREATORS WHO TRANSFORMS THIS SMALL SCALE INTO A BOLD IDENTITY THROUGH HIS PURSUIT OF REALISM IN WHEEL AND TIRE PRODUCTION. IN THIS INTERVIEW, WE TAKE A CLOSER LOOK AT HIS CREATIVE JOURNEY, FROM INSPIRATION TO PRODUCTION PHILOSOPHY.

BULUT GEZER: How did you start producing 1/64 scale wheels and tires? What was the main source of inspiration that led you into this field?

UTKU KANAT: About four to five years ago, I started working with 1/64 scale models by doing custom projects—stripping the paint off older cars, repainting them, and adding wheels and decals. At that time, finding affordable rubber wheels was almost impossible. My solution was to buy relatively cheap premium Hot Wheels models, remove their rubber tires, and use them on my own customs.

Over time, dismantling a separate premium model for every new custom became both costly and time-consuming. It was during this period that I met Aral Deveci, the person who taught me this hobby and whom I still value greatly today. He explained that I could produce 1/64 scale wheels using a 3D printer and even design my own tires. For quite a long time, he supported me by sending me the wheels he produced himself.

Eventually, he encouraged me by saying, “It’s time for you to get your own printer and start producing—you can do this.” Motivated by his belief in me, I decided to purchase my first 3D printer and begin producing my own wheels. Without a doubt, my greatest source of inspiration in starting this journey is Aral Deveci.



BG: Which materials and techniques do you prefer during the production process? Are there any specific technical details you focus on to reflect real automotive dynamics as accurately as possible?

UK: Throughout the production process, my primary focus is on durability and realism. Since we are working at 1/64 scale, the diameter of a wheel is roughly 1 cm, which makes standard resin prints quite fragile. Over time, this led me to develop and use a custom resin blend of my own. Thanks to this special mixture, I can achieve very fine details while also ensuring that the wheels remain highly durable despite their small size.

From a technical perspective, I aim to stay as faithful as possible to real automotive wheels. I base my designs directly on real wheel blueprints, carefully scaling elements such as offset, depth, spoke structure, and center form to fit 1/64 scale while preserving real-world proportions. The more realistic a wheel looks, the better it sits on the model—and the more attention it attracts from collectors.



BG: When designing a wheel or tire, what criteria do you prioritize the most? Scale accuracy, aesthetics, or the sense of performance?

UK: If I had to answer this question with a single word, it would be “balance”—or what I personally like to call the “golden ratio.” When designing a wheel, scale accuracy, aesthetics, and a sense of performance are three core criteria that I simply cannot separate. If you focus solely on aesthetics, the product becomes fragile; if you focus only on durability, you risk losing realism and design identity. For me, the key is bringing these three elements together at the highest possible level. I preserve scale accuracy, replicate aesthetic details directly from real wheels, and apply technical adjustments to ensure durability. To create a model that is consistently producible and satisfying for users, all three aspects must work in harmony. In short, they are all equally important—and they complement one another.

BG: Do you offer customization options for collectors and custom model builders? For example, different colorways, sizes, or tread patterns.

UK: Yes, absolutely. Personalization is one of the things collectors and custom builders value most, so I make sure to offer a wide range of options. Currently, I provide three different sizes: 9 mm, 10 mm, and 11 mm. In terms of finishes, I offer four main options: gold, chrome, black, and white.

As for variety, the catalog is quite extensive. At the moment, I produce 158 standard series models and 20 special series models—resulting in hundreds of different wheel designs overall. Moreover, I continue to expand this range by adding new models on a monthly basis. In short, I believe I more than meet collectors’ personalization needs in terms of size, color, and model diversity.





A WORLD BUILT ON DETAIL AND DEDICATION

BG: Are there any new projects or special series you are planning to add to your production line in the near future?

UK: Yes, there are many new projects we plan to introduce in the near future. We are entering a period where we will place a stronger emphasis on special series wheels. Our goal is to expand limited-production models that collectors find particularly appealing, offering designs that are both more detailed and more original. The special series we currently release each month will increasingly become concept-based sets with their own stories and themes.

In addition, we are planning to expand our production line beyond wheels by introducing miniature diorama products. These will include 1/64 scale garage details, display platforms, and themed scenes that allow collectors to showcase their models in a more striking and immersive way. Our aim is to move beyond being just a wheel brand and instead build a broader ecosystem that supports and enhances the overall collecting culture.

In short, the upcoming period is filled with exciting projects that will elevate both product diversity and the overall collector experience to a much higher level.



UTKU KANAT'S PURSUIT OF REALISM IN WHEELS AND TIRES PROVES THAT 1/64 IS NOT JUST A SCALE, BUT A LANGUAGE OF CHARACTER SHAPED BY VISION, PATIENCE, AND PASSION. HIS APPROACH REMINDS US THAT IN THE DIECAST WORLD, DETAILS ARE NOT ORNAMENTS – THEY ARE THE VERY ESSENCE OF IDENTITY.

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MAJORETTE IS LOVE: FROM A CHILDHOOD PASSION TO A GLOBAL COLLECTORS' COMMUNITY



SOME PASSIONS BEGIN IN CHILDHOOD AND CONTINUE TO GROW WITHOUT EVER FADING. FOR HÜSEYİN YEŞİLTAS, MAJORETTE MODELS ARE NOT MERELY DIECAST CARS; THEY REPRESENT A LIFELONG JOURNEY SHAPED BY MEMORIES, DEDICATION, AND FRIENDSHIPS. IN THIS INTERVIEW, WE EXPLORE HOW A CHILDHOOD LOVE EVOLVED INTO TURKEY'S FIRST MULTINATIONAL MAJORETTE COMMUNITY, THE CORE VALUES OF TRUE COLLECTING, AND HOW THIS POWERFUL BOND CONTINUES TO GROW TOWARD THE FUTURE.

BULUT GEZER: How did your interest in Majorette begin? Why does this brand hold a special place for you?

HÜSEYİN YEŞİLTAS: Dear Brother Bulut, first of all, I would like to sincerely thank you for bringing this wonderful magazine to us model collectors.

My interest in Majorette models began in the late 1980s, when I was around 8–9 years old. As a child, saving my pocket money to buy Majorette models was my greatest joy. I can truly say that Majorette is my childhood love and my very first passion.

What makes Majorette special for me is not only its details, suspension system, and paint quality, but also the emotional connection it creates. The passion that started with the very first model I bought in my childhood – the Alfa Romeo 75 – still takes me back to those days every time I add a new model to my collection.

BG: How did the Majorette community in Turkey come together? What was your biggest motivation in founding this group?

HY: In 2020, during the peak of the pandemic when we were all confined to our homes, I followed various 1/64 scale model groups on Facebook and realized that there was no community dedicated solely to Majorette models. On the night of April 30th, leading into May 1st, I founded the Majorette Lovers Club Turkey Facebook group.

When I examined existing model groups in Turkey, I noticed that they mostly consisted of participants only from within the country. My biggest goal was to create an international group – a global community where people from all over the world could connect, communicate, and share their passion in an environment built on love, respect, kindness, and mutual support.

The interest in our group, founded on May 1, 2020, was overwhelming. Esteemed collectors from Turkey who had dedicated many years to Majorette joined us, and we also invited highly respected collectors from abroad. Thus, we planted the first seeds of a truly high-quality community.

Today, we proudly stand as Turkey's first and only multinational Majorette group, with 2,980 members from 100 different countries worldwide. Everyone has contributed immensely to bringing the group to this level, and I would like to sincerely thank all our friends once again.

I would also like to express my deepest gratitude, on behalf of myself and our group, to Mr. Şakir Çakın, who became General Manager of Simba Toys Turkey in 2021 and has played a vital role in bringing beautiful Majorette models to collectors in Turkey, while continuously supporting our community.

Without a doubt, my greatest motivation has always been the growing interest, enthusiasm, and the trust people have placed in me.



BG: From your perspective, what are the key features that distinguish Majorette models from other brands?

HY: For me, the most distinctive features of Majorette models are their detailed designs, suspension systems, opening doors, trunks, and engine hoods. Additionally, their slightly larger scale compared to other brands gives them a unique presence and realism.

BG: If you had to choose three models from your collection that hold special meaning for you, which ones would they be and why?

HY: The most special models for me are my childhood pieces. Their memories, joy, and the happiness they bring are truly priceless.

My most cherished model is the 1988 original France-made Alfa Romeo 75, which was my very first Majorette model. I would also like to personally thank you once again for fully restoring this model with incredible craftsmanship and dedication, bringing it back to its original condition.

Two other models that hold great sentimental value for me are the Toyota Hiace minibus and the Toyota Pickup 4x4.



MORE THAN A BRAND: MAJORETTE

BG: How do you think diecast collecting in Turkey has changed over the years? How do you evaluate today's community culture?

HY: Collecting means cooperation, kindness, respect, love, patience, and sharing. There are many highly respected seniors, friends, and fellow collectors who have devoted years to this hobby and truly embody these values.

However, especially among the newer generation, there is a significant group more focused on accumulation, buying and selling, and creating black markets rather than true collecting. Unfortunately, this makes it very difficult for genuine collectors to find models and can cause people to drift away from the hobby.

Personally, I try to encourage and support many young collectors, helping them take their first steps toward becoming true collectors.

Thanks to this hobby, we have built wonderful friendships. Through our Majorette group, we have met collectors from different religions, languages, and cultures. We have exchanged gifts, supported each other, and formed truly meaningful bonds.





BG: What is the most valuable advice you would give to new collectors, whether young or adult?

HY: My advice to anyone starting a collection is to enjoy their models and be patient. Instead of being upset about models they don't have, they should appreciate and enjoy the ones they do own. Building friendships and practicing this hobby with love, respect, kindness, and mutual support is what truly matters.

BG: Do you have any future projects, events, or community goals planned for the Majorette Turkey group?

HY: For the Majorette Lovers Club Turkey, I am planning to organize an open-air gathering or festival where all Majorette enthusiasts can come together.

Currently, within our Facebook group, we organize weekend brand and model events, mosaic puzzles, anniversary gift raffles, and at the beginning of each month, we publicly acknowledge and thank the top 10 members who contribute the most and the top 10 members who receive the most likes.

In November 2023, we held our first Vintage Models Duel Competition, during which more than 1,750 posts were shared in just five hours. We had an incredible time and plan to organize similar events again in the future.

Thank you very much, dear brother Bulut Gezer, for this wonderful interview. I invite all hobby enthusiasts to follow our Majorette Lovers Club Turkey Facebook and Instagram groups.

With love and respect, let us continue to enjoy and honor our hobby in the best possible way.

Majorette is LOVE.

Hüseyin Yeşiltaş

Founder of Majorette Lovers Club Turkey

HÜSEYİN YEŞİLTAŞ'S JOURNEY WITH MAJORETTE REMINDS US THAT COLLECTING IS FAR MORE THAN SIMPLY ACQUIRING MODELS. BUILT ON LOVE, RESPECT, SHARING, AND PATIENCE, THIS CULTURE BRINGS TOGETHER PEOPLE FROM DIFFERENT CORNERS OF THE WORLD THROUGH A SHARED PASSION. MAJORETTE LOVERS CLUB



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MAJORETTE LOVERS CLUB TURKEY

PHOTOGRAPH HÜSEYİN YEŞİLTAŞ



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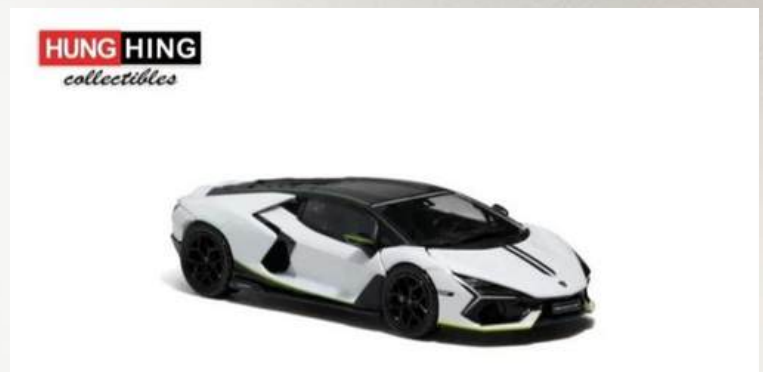




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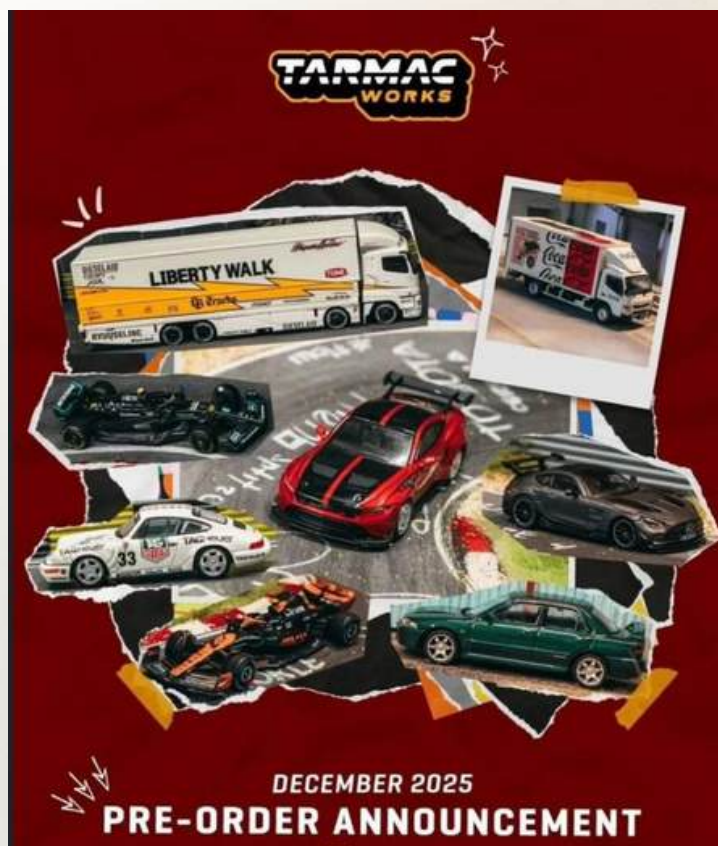


UPCOMING RELEASES



WHAT'S NEXT IN THE MINI WORLD

UPCOMING RELEASES



WHAT'S NEXT IN THE MINI WORLD

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CUSTOM TOW TRUCK



1/64 SCALE MODEL
ITEM: MT6405A14
METALLIC GREEN



REXY

HIDDEN EDITION



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300 SEL S-KLUB



STREET WEAPON



Diablo SV



1/64 SCALE MODEL
ITEM: MT6413A1
METALLIC YELLOW



The Diablo SV was introduced in 1995 at the Geneva Motor Show, reviving the Super Veloce title first used on the Miura SV. The SV is based on the standard Diablo and thus lacks the four-wheel drive system of the VT. A notable feature of the SV is an increase in power output to 510 PS at 7,100 rpm and 580 N.m of torque at 5,900 rpm which, paired with the rear-wheel drive layout, can increase the likelihood of loss of traction during hard driving.



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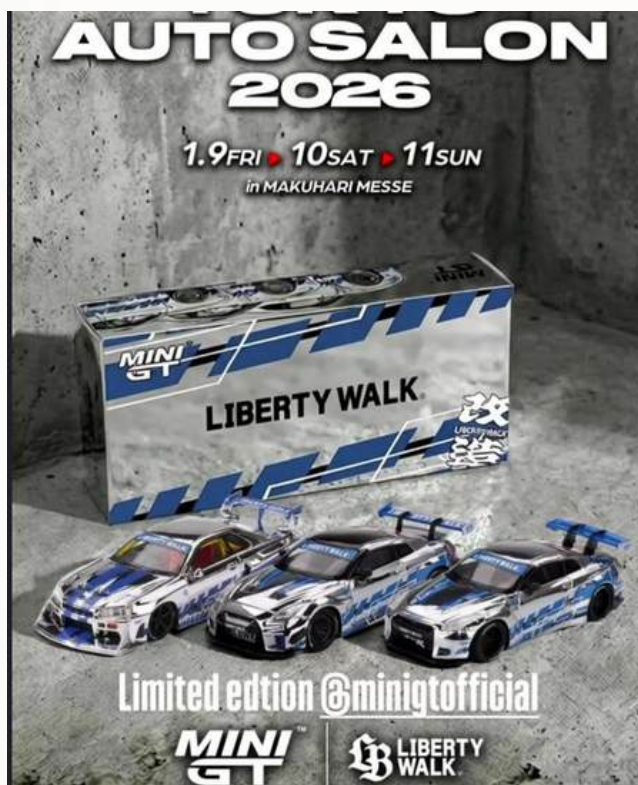
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COLLECTORS WHO MADE THIS ISSUE POSSIBLE**

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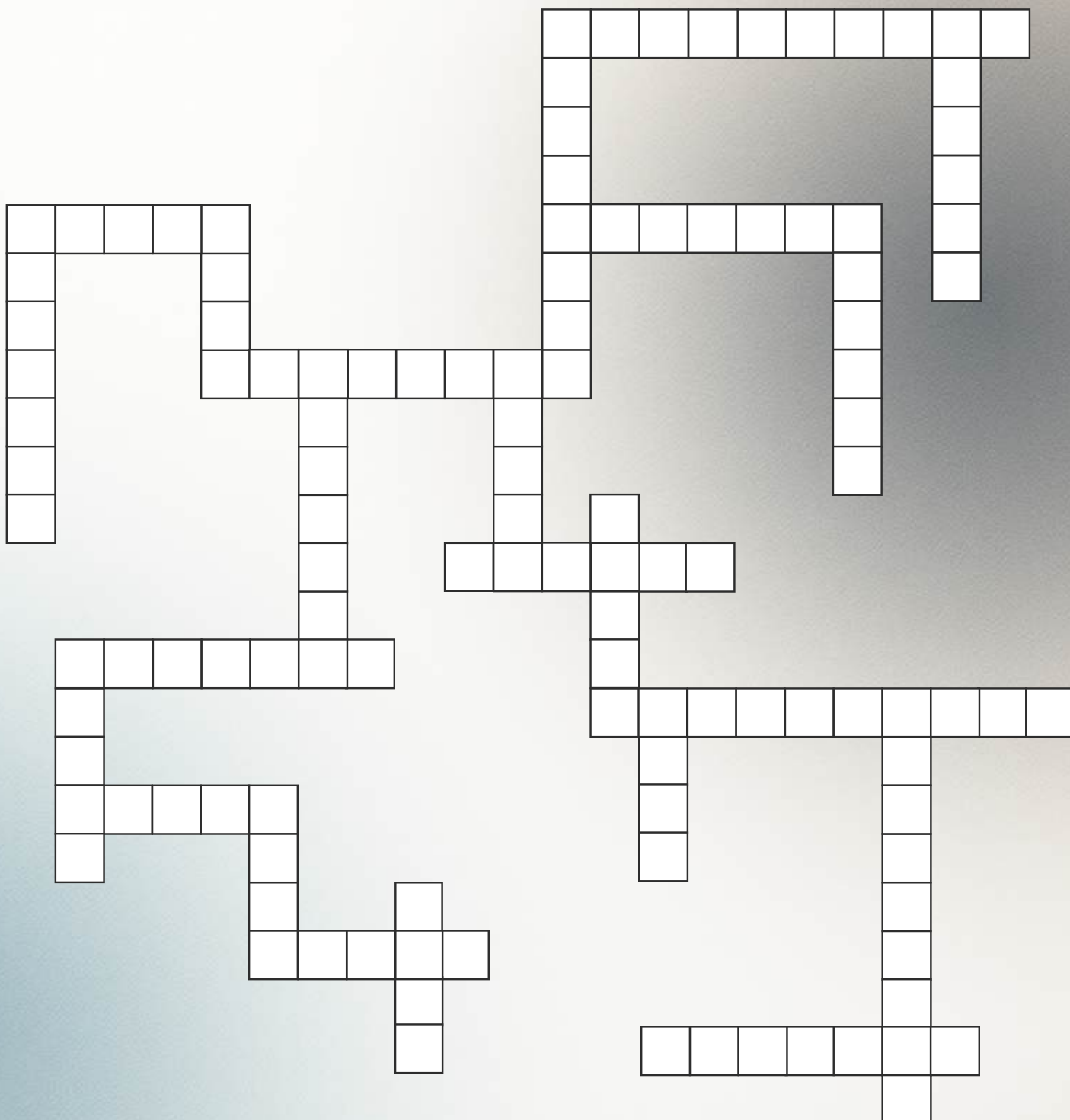
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COVER IMAGE: BMW M2 G87 1/64 HOWIE MODEL WITH ZUKURI PROJEKT WHEELS
PHOTOS BY: ANTHONYPHOTOWORKS2



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